

New Cat First Weeks Survival Guide — Action Checklist

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SET UP THE SANCTUARY ROOM

- ☐ **Sanctuary Room:** Set up one room with a litter box placed away from food, a water station, a hiding spot like an open carrier with a cushion, and their food bowl as the only items inside.
- ☐ **Feliway Diffuser:** Plug a Feliway diffuser into an outlet near your cat's hiding spot in the sanctuary room to release calming pheromones that help reduce stress-related behaviors during the adjustment period.
- ☐ **Blinds and Curtains:** Keep all blinds and curtains closed in the sanctuary room during the first week to prevent visual stress from 窗外 movement like birds, people, or other cats.
- ☐ **Week 2 Additions:** Once your cat is reliably eating and using the litter box by day 5-7, introduce a cat tree near a window for daytime viewing and install a second litter box in a separate area.

ESTABLISH THE EVENING ROUTINE

- ☐ **Evening Sequence:** Conduct a 15-minute play session at 9:30pm followed by a final meal at 10:30-11pm so the hunting instinct exhausts before sleep and digestion causes drowsiness.
- ☐ **Final Meal Timing:** Move your cat's last meal to your bedtime (10:30pm or 11pm) to reduce the natural alertness window that occurs after eating and prevent 3am crying sessions.
- ☐ **30-Minute Rule:** After you go to bed, ignore your cat's crying for the full 30 minutes without getting up, turning on lights, or responding in any way to break the attention-seeking cycle.
- ☐ **Consistent Schedule:** Feed your cat at the same times every single day because predictability reduces anxiety and helps their internal clock reset faster than unpredictable feeding patterns.

MONITOR AND KNOW WHEN TO ACT

- ☐ **Emergency Vet Signs:** Call your vet immediately if your cat strains to urinate, produces only small amounts, or stops eating for more than 24 hours, as these can indicate serious health issues.
 - ☐ **Track Progress:** Monitor whether nighttime crying sessions shorten from 30 minutes toward 10 minutes or less, your cat eats consistently, comes out of hiding more often, and uses the litter box regularly.
 - ☐ **Territory Expansion:** Open one new room per day starting around day 10 once your cat reliably eats and uses the litter box, letting them explore for 30 minutes before closing the door each time.
 - ☐ **Persistent Distress:** Contact your veterinarian if your cat continues crying intensely for over 2 hours each night by day 21 with no improvement, as professional intervention may help with severe adjustment issues.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.